

Mozilla's commitment to providing the best web experience to all users of the internet.

Some rather interesting challenges present themselves on the Android platform. We'd just like to take a minute and acknowledge how meta it feels to develop what's essentially an app for an app on a mobile operating system. Anyway, back to the point – Android doesn't support XUL, and every add-on must be restartless on the platform. When you think about it, both of the restrictions seem very reasonable, as one can't expect a mobile user to really shut down and restart an application to use an extension. Now, getting your desktop add-on to comply with such significant restrictions is a rather difficult job, but then that's what the SDK was developed for – to make



Fennec, the Firefox for Android

the job of the developers easy! The SDK allows you to develop for the mobile platform as well, but is accompanied by relevant flags. Because it's so early in the stage of development, it doesn't (yet) allow the developer to extend the degree of control which it does on other platforms. But that doesn't mean it won't do so in the future. Also, the

much-loved PageMod has been implemented almost entirely on the system, which means that you can change the look and feel of the pages with suitable tools. With the chronic lack of chrome that the platform provides (and the great focus on the page rather than the browser that Firefox seems to be pushing for at the moment), that will probably be the most important and recurring use case for the mobile-based add-ons anyway.

Boot to Gecko (B2G)

Boot to Gecko (B2G) is the official moniker for Firefox OS. As you can guess by the name, Boot2Gecko attempts to cut out the middleman and have the whole phone just running Firefox and apps. The extent to it manages to do this is surprising – the structure of the OS is such that all the apps on the system are structurally similar, in that they follow the general struc-